

```
$ e2fsck -f /dev/debian/home
```

Run *e2fsck*, a file system check utility that checks for bad sectors and I/O errors related to HDD. This helps in fixing errors in the file system.

```
$ resize2fs /dev/debian/home 'size'G
$ lyresize -L 'size'G /dev/debian/home
```

Replace 'size' with the value of your choice (in GB). This will shrink or resize the */home* partition to the specified 'size'.

```
$ mount -a
```

This command will mount all the partitions mentioned in *fstab* (*/etc/fstab*). *fstab* lists all the available disks and disk partitions.

```
$ lvextend -L +'root_size'G /dev/debian/root
$ resize2fs /dev/debian/root
```

Here we are appending 'root_size' (in GB) to the root partition. Replace 'root_size' with the value you want to append to the root partition.

```
$ init 5
```

The above command will restart the system normally. Now, you have successfully resized your partition without reinstalling the operating system.

— Jackson Isaac, jacksonisaac2008@gmail.com

Know what everybody is up to on a shared server

On a shared server, we may want to know if anyone is doing something suspicious that is troubling others, like slowing down the machine. Run the following command:

```
#w
```

w displays information about the users currently on the machine and the processes they are using. The output is shown in the following order: the current time, how long the system has been running, how many users are currently logged on, and the system load averages for the past 1, 5 and 15 minutes.

— Madhusudana Y N, madhusudanayn@gmail.com

Is your server a physical or virtual machine?

Just suppose you do an SSH login to a GNU/Linux machine and would like to figure out whether it is a

physical or a virtual machine. Here is a command that will disclose that status of the server:

```
#dmidecode
```

This command gives details of the hardware.

If it is a physical machine, then the output will display the product's name in a manner similar to what follows:

```
[bash]$ dmidecode | grep "Product"
Product Name: PowerEdge 1750
```

If it is a virtual machine, then the output will be something like this:

```
[bash]$ dmidecode | grep Product
Product Name: VMware Virtual Platform
Product Name: 440BX Desktop Reference Platform
```

— Narendra Kangralkar, narendrakangralkar@gmail.com

Disable 'automatic image loading' in Firefox

Web browser users sometimes need to disable auto-loading of images to limit bandwidth consumption, examine untrusted websites and for a few more reasons. This has become difficult to accomplish with recent versions of the Firefox Web browser. But here's how you can do it:

- 1) Type 'about:config' in the Web address box of Firefox and hit 'Enter'.
- 2) Click the button labelled 'I'll be careful, I promise!'
- 3) Type 'permissions.default.image' in the search bar that appears below the address box.
- 4) Double-click the text '1' against the search result by the aforementioned key phrase 'permissions.default.image'.
- 5) Change the value from '1' to '2' and hit 'OK'.
- 6) Visit a site or close the tab.

To revert to auto-loading of images, just change the '2' back to '1' following a similar procedure. Please do not commit any typographic errors or the results can be disastrous!

—A Datta, webmaster@aucklandwhich.org

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The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.opensourceforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.